

*Fridays are for Nothing*

For the majority of most days, River rots in court, and Quin on paper. Every Thursday, however, they meet after work for cakes, cheese, and a mutual reprieve. Presently, it is teatime, and the kettle has just started to warm.

“What ever happened to my favorite client?” I pop open a bottle of Kava from between my bare thighs. The cork flies by River’s right ear. It hits the kitchen’s accent wall leaving a tan dimple. We both laugh. River glances at the cork on the ground, and moves to the counters corner.

With a gentle push from their wrists on my waist, I’m trapped. I can feel River’s breath on my lips. It smells of warm bread and ash. Our hips are touching at their most elongated points.

River reaches down. They gently pull the bottle with one hand. Although it’s a careful tug, I yip. A bit of wine runs down my leg. I close my eyes and feel their tongue, then their body arching up, and finally a bare belly near my face.

I open my eyes to notice there’s a small date centered above the right hip. With their two longest fingers, River grabs the glasses from above.

“The one who shot that asshole?” River asks, dropping on their heels.

They pour while holding the glasses in one hand. I tighten as the fizz bubbles up to the brims. River places the glasses on the countertop. Not a drop drips this time.

“You smell like smoke and I need to get that pot.” I say, thrusting my way out. I watch River grin, pull out a silver case, and light up. After two pulls, the cigarette is jabbed my way. We take our drinks to the circular kitchen table. River lights up a second one.

We both begin to laugh.

“Why are you beaming?” I ask, hovering above their cup.

I put the pot down, and finish my wine. I pour another glass.

“He wore that stupid shirt to court after I told him not to.”

“Was that a growl?” I pour a full glass for River.

“Honestly, why Quin? Do you know what he...” I cut River off.

“That’s what they do.” I look up.

“You spend your day drawing, hon. Trust me.” River snuffs the cigarette, and squints at me. I copy.

“Hon.” River is turning red again. “If not me then who?”

The blue in their eyes whitens.

“What is it?” River asks.

“The cake I made us.” I start to laugh. “You haven’t eaten any.” It quickly turns into a giggle, then tears.

I hear the chair scoot closer. I smile. River places my head between their shoulder and neck.

“I love your baking.” River says. “You know that.”

“I know.” I sniff.

We both squeeze. I am trapped between River’s head, shoulder, and arms.

“I love you doll. Let’s start our weekend tonight?”

“Really?”

“Yeah, fuck it. I don’t need to go in tomorrow.” River laughs. “He took the deal.”

I go into the kitchen and grab another bottle from the fridge. This time I take careful aim. River turns to look at me. Our eyes meet just as I wiggle the cork loose. It pops.

